SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

22 October 2024 · Shift 3

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 15 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 12 questions

Q.2

Find the average of the the first 15 multiples of 5.

(A) 45
(B) 35
(C) 30
(D) 40

Q.3

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 3% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 460
(B) 360
(C) 380
(D) 420

Q.4

The mean of the first 7 odd prime numbers is (rounded off to two decimal places):

(A) 5.41
(B) 8.61
(C) 7.91
(D) 10.71

Q.5

The cost price of some table lamps is ₹25,000. The shopkeeper will get ₹15,000 more If he sells these table lamps for ₹1,200 per lamp instead of ₹900 per lamp. Find the selling price of 23 table lamps if he earned 21% profit.

(A) ₹12,919
(B) ₹14,917
(C) ₹12,585
(D) ₹13,915

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 1010
(B) 1090
(C) 990
(D) 1050

Q.7

Ravi walks a circular track of 1680m in circumference. If the speed of Ravi is 140m/min, then the time to cover one round is equal to:

(A) 8 min
(B) 14 min
(C) 12 min
(D) 10 min

Q.8

A train 315 m long is running at a speed of 54 km/h. What time will it take to cross a pole on its route?

(A) 18 s
(B) 20 s
(C) 21 s
(D) 19 s

Q.10

Find the LCM of 9, 21 and 63

(A) 63
(B) 9
(C) 3
(D) 72

Q.13

A's salary increases by 60% and then decreases by 30%. On the whole, A's salary is increased by _____?

(A) 48%
(B) 72%
(C) 30%
(D) 12%

Q.14

If the cost price of an article is 70.5% of its selling price, what is the profit percentage (rounded off to 1 decimal place)?

(A) 42.7%
(B) 41.8%
(C) 39.5%
(D) 51.6%

Q.16

Find the fourth proportional of 4a + 7, 11a + 3 and 6a if a = 2.

(A) 25
(B) 15
(C) 30
(D) 20

Q.20

The average weight of 16 containers is 80 kg. If 8 new containers are added, the new average increases by 2.5 kg. The average weight of the 8 new containers is:

(A) 87 kg
(B) 87.5 kg
(C) 82.5 kg
(D) 160 kg

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.2

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13, can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (18, 16, 34) (21, 43, 64)

(A) (23, 12, 76)
(B) (39, 10, 53)
(C) (32, 10, 42)
(D) (22, 41, 73)

Q.3

Six people—A, B, C, D, E, and F—are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). A is an immediate neighbour of both E and F. C is second to the left of F. B is not is an immediate neighbour of E. What is the position of D?

(A) Second to the right of B
(B) Immediate left of C
(C) Immediate left of A
(D) Immediate left of F

Q.4

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 56 ÷ 8 × 45 + 4 – 23 = 164

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) – and ×
(C) – and +
(D) + and ×

Q.6

JJDA is related to QQKH in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, ENHE is related to LUOL. To which of the following is TTNK related, following the same logic?

(A) AUAR
(B) AAUR
(C) URAA
(D) AURA

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'LOST' is coded as '5197' and 'TURN' is coded as '4562'. What is the code for 'T' in that language?

(A) 2
(B) 5
(C) 7
(D) 4

Q.8

127 is related to 218 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 3 is related to 10.To which of the following is 29 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 67
(B) 66
(C) 68
(D) 63

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'EXIT' is coded as '1937' and 'ZERO' is coded as '6829'.What is the code for 'E' in the given code language?

(A) 8
(B) 2
(C) 9
(D) 1

Q.11

FRNQ is related to LXTW in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, XJFI is related to DPLO. To which of the following is VHDG related, following the same logic?

(A) BMNJ
(B) MNJB
(C) BNJM
(D) BJMN

Q.13

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '÷' and '+' are interchanged and '–' and '×' are interchanged? 13 – 3 ÷ 4 – 9 ÷ 10 – 3 × 20 + 5= ?

(A) –15
(B) 101
(C) 86
(D) 111

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'car is fast'' is written as 'gq ip eb' and 'fast and furious' is writtenas 'hp qm ip'. How is 'fast' writtenin the given language?

(A) hp
(B) eb
(C) gq
(D) ip

Q.15

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). G sits third to the right of A. D sits third to the right of G. E is an immediate neighbour of both A and F. C sits third to the right of F. How many people sit between E and D when counted from the right of E?

(A) 4
(B) 1
(C) 3
(D) 2

Q.16

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 33, 37, 46, 62, 87, ?

(A) 123
(B) 122
(C) 121
(D) 124

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All papers are files. All files are secret. Conclusions: (I) All papers are secret. (II) All secrets are files.

(A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) is follow .
(B) Only conclusion (II) is follow .
(C) Only conclusion (I) is follow .
(D) Both conclusions (I) and (II) are follow .

Q.18

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All oranges are apples. Some apples are kiwis. Conclusions: (I) Some oranges are not kiwis. (II) All apples are oranges.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Both conclusion I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.20

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? EFD, JKI, OPN, TUS, ?

(A) EVF
(B) YZX
(C) GUH
(D) EFU

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Tirot Sing was the leader of which of the following revolts?

(A) Sanyasi Revolt
(B) Poligars's Revolt
(C) Khasi uprising
(D) Singpho's Rebellion

Q.2

In India, who introduced the idea of the poverty line for the first time?

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Dadabhai Naoroji
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Dr. BR Ambedkar

Q.3

In which of the following years did Lord Curzon announce the partition of Bengal?

(A) 1900
(B) 1909
(C) 1905
(D) 1914

Q.4

_____ dance is embedded in the stories from the epics Mahabharata, Ramayana and Puranas.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Kathakali
(C) Odissi
(D) Sattriya

Q.5

In which language was 'Mudraraksha' play written by Vishakhadatta?

(A) Tamil
(B) Sanskrit
(C) Hindi
(D) Telugu

Q.6

The Dravidian style of temple architecture can be largely seen from which part of India?

(A) Eastern India
(B) Northern India
(C) Southern India
(D) Western India

Q.7

Which of the following is NOT a qualification/eligibility to become the President of India?

(A) Must be qualified for election as a member of the house of the people
(B) Must have completed the age of thirty-five years
(C) Must be a citizen of India
(D) Must hold any office of profit

Q.8

Which of the following dynasties of the Delhi Sultanate finally annexed Jaunpur into the empire of Delhi Sultanate?

(A) Lodi dynasty
(B) Sayyid dynasty
(C) Khalji dynasty
(D) Tughlaq dynasty

Q.9

The property by virtue of which carbon can form a C-C covalent bond is called _____.

(A) allotropy
(B) covalency
(C) tetravalency
(D) catenation

Q.10

Losoong festival is predominantly celebrated in Sikkim by which of the following tribes?

(A) Kurumba
(B) Khasi
(C) Bhil
(D) Bhutia

Q.11

_____ received Padma Shri 2017 award for being an exponent of Nagpuri folk dance Jhumar.

(A) Mukund Nayak
(B) Purushottam Upadhyay
(C) Laishram Birendrakumar Singh
(D) Chemancheri Kunhiraman Nair

Q.12

In 2018, Ganesh and Kumaresh Rajagopalan won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Carnatic instrumental music. For playing which instrument did they win this award?

(A) Violin
(B) Sarangi
(C) Veena
(D) Sarod

Q.13

Which of the following diseases is detected by the Widal test?

(A) Pneumonia
(B) Diphtheria
(C) Typhoid
(D) Influenza

Q.14
To which state does the Indian tennis player Sumit Nagal belong?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Odisha
(C) Haryana
(D) Karnataka

Q.15
Which Indian Member of Parliament was given the 'India UK Outstanding Achievers Honour' in January 2023?

(A) Hemant Shriram Patil
(B) Haji Fazlur Rehman
(C) Hanuman Beniwal
(D) Raghav Chadha

Q.16
Which of the following events and their hosts is correctly matched?

(A) ICC World Cup Men Cricket 2015 – India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh
(B) ICC World Cup Men Cricket 2019 – England and Wales
(C) ICC World Cup Men Cricket 2007 – England
(D) ICC World Cup Men Cricket 2011 – Australia and New Zealand

Q.17
Layers of varying thickness are found in which type of rock?

(A) Volcanic rock
(B) Igneous rock
(C) Sedimentary rock
(D) Metamorphic rock

Q.18
The Panchpatmali mineral deposit region is located in which state from the following?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Odisha
(D) Haryana

Q.19
Constipation could be a sign that the person in suffering from a lack of _____.

(A) Calcium
(B) Vitamin
(C) Dietary Fibre
(D) Protein

Q.20
The Directive Principles of State Policy in the Indian Constitution are borrowed from which country's constitution?

(A) The Constitution of the Soviet Union
(B) The Constitution of the United Kingdom
(C) The Constitution of Ireland
(D) The Constitution of the United States

Q.21
In 2023, the Government of India has proposed to set up how many new ‘Waste to Wealth’ plants under GOBARdhan?

(A) 250
(B) 300
(C) 450
(D) 500

Q.22
Who wrote the novel 'The Catcher in the Rye'?

(A) JD Salinger
(B) Ernest Hemingway
(C) HG Wells
(D) Mark Twain

Q.23
What does M stand for in BHIM-UPI?

(A) Monetary
(B) Mobile
(C) Money
(D) Monthly

Q.24
As per Census 2011, what is the literacy rate of India?

(A) 65.46%
(B) 82.14%
(C) 70%
(D) 74.04%

Q.25
Which is the largest agro-based Industry of India?

(A) Cotton textile industry
(B) Edible oil industry
(C) Tea industry
(D) Sugar industry

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.1
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) calender
(B) tabular
(C) lying
(D) written

Q.2
The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Spanish person are well known worldwide / for their warm hospitality / and food.

(A) and food
(B) Spanish person are well known worldwide
(C) No error
(D) for their warm hospitality

Q.3
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. They reinvested in their trades and indulged in "unobtrusive" consumption at home.

(A) Preposterous
(B) Conspicuous
(C) Faint
(D) Obscure

Q.4
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Universal high-quality education is the best way forward for developing and maximising our country's rich talents and resources for the "good in the individual", the society, the country and the world.

(A) good by the individual
(B) good of the individual
(C) good for the individual
(D) good on the individual

Q.5
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My mother always _____ to help people.

(A) takes a rain check
(B) breaks the bank
(C) turns a deaf ear
(D) goes the extra mile

Q.6
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Recluse

(A) Closeness
(B) Solitary
(C) Sociable
(D) Candid

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Intractable

(A) Proper
(B) Compliant
(C) Versatile
(D) Defiant

Q.8

Select the correctly spelled sentence.

(A) The athlete ran quickley across the finish line.
(B) The athlete ran quickly across the finish line.
(C) The athlet ran quicly across the finnish line.
(D) The athelete ran quicly across the finish line.

Q.10

Select the grammatically correct sentence.

(A) Having belief in yourself is the big key to success.
(B) Having belief in yourself is the biggest key to success.
(C) Having beliefs in yourself is the bigger key to success.
(D) Having belief in yourself is the most bigger key to success.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. It is being asked why there has been no _____ taken yet.

(A) attribution
(B) simplification
(C) distribution
(D) action

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. Indeed, Jack is one of “the clever” men I have ever met.

(A) the cleverest
(B) cleverer
(C) most clever
(D) clever

Q.14

Identify the sentence with an error with respect to the use of present tense.

(A) She has sung romantic songs.
(B) She sings romantic songs.
(C) She has been singing songs.
(D) She singing romantic songs.

Q.15

Select the grammatically correct sentence from the given options.

(A) It is strange to see a guy shouting in the mall without any reason.
(B) It is too stranger to see a guy shouting in the mall without any reason.
(C) It is too stranger to see a guy shouting in the mall beside any reason.
(D) It is too stranger to see a guy shout in the mall without any reason.

Q.16

Select the option that rectifies the spelling error of the underlined word. Preserving our planet's biodiversity is essential for the health and “susteinability” of ecosystems and human life.

(A) sustainability
(B) sustainabelity
(C) sustanbility
(D) susteinabelety

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. It is “all one” whether I go today or tomorrow.

(A) in one piece
(B) just the same
(C) proper
(D) together

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Constant efforts to achieve something

(A) Perspicacious
(B) Euphemism
(C) Perseverance
(D) Recant

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The street is crowded. You could easily get lost in this _____.

(A) phase
(B) faze
(C) maze
(D) maize

Q.20

Which of the following words is a synonym of 'Evanescent'?

(A) Exemplary
(B) Fleeting
(C) Imitation
(D) Delicious

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It (1)_____ no discriminations to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to (2)_____ the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by (3)_____ needs, and to give priority to the (4)_____ urgent cases of distress. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace (5)_____ all people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) had made
(B) make
(C) makes
(D) made

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It (1)_____ no discriminations to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to (2)_____ the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by (3)_____ needs, and to give priority to the (4)_____ urgent cases of distress. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace (5)_____ all people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) clear
(B) increase
(C) relieve
(D) decreased

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It (1)_____ no discriminations to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to (2)_____ the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by (3)_____ needs, and to give priority to the (4)_____ urgent cases of distress. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace (5)_____ all people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) his
(B) her
(C) your
(D) their

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It (1)_____ no discriminations to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to (2)_____ the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by (3)_____ needs, and to give priority to the (4)_____ urgent cases of distress. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace (5)_____ all people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) least
(B) most
(C) high
(D) more

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It (1)_____ no discriminations to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to (2)_____ the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by (3)_____ needs, and to give priority to the (4)_____ urgent cases of distress. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace (5)_____ all people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) into
(B) at
(C) amongst
(D) of

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (D) 40

The first 15 multiples of 5 run from 5 to 75, so their average is (5 + 75)/2 = 40.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 420

SI = 3500 × 3 × 4/100 = ₹420.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 10.71

The first seven odd primes are 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, 17 and 19, which add up to 75. 75/7 = 10.71.

Q.5 · Answer (D) ₹13,915

₹300 more a lamp brings ₹15,000 more, so there are 15,000/300 = 50 lamps, costing 25,000/50 = ₹500 each. At 21% profit one sells for ₹605, so 23 sell for 23 × 605 = ₹13,915.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 1050

SI = 3500 × 5 × 6/100 = ₹1,050.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 12 min

One round takes 1680/140 = 12 minutes.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 21 s

54 km/h = 54 × 5/18 = 15 m/s. To pass a pole the train covers its own length: 315/15 = 21 s.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 63

63 = 3^2 × 7 contains both 9 = 3^2 and 21 = 3 × 7, so the LCM is 63 itself.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 12%

A 60% rise and then a 30% fall multiply the salary by 1.6 × 0.7 = 1.12: a net increase of 12%.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 41.8%

Taking the selling price as 100, the cost price is 70.5 and the profit 29.5, so the profit percentage is 29.5/70.5 × 100 = 41.84%, or 41.8%.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 20

With a = 2 the numbers are 15, 25 and 12. The fourth proportional x satisfies 15 : 25 = 12 : x, so x = 25 × 12/15 = 20.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 87.5 kg

The 16 containers weigh 16 × 80 = 1,280 kg and all 24 weigh 24 × 82.5 = 1,980 kg. The 8 new ones weigh 700 kg: 87.5 kg on average.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 · Answer (C) (32, 10, 42)

In each set the third number is the sum of the first two: 18 + 16 = 34 and 21 + 43 = 64. Likewise 32 + 10 = 42.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Immediate left of C

C is second to the left of F, so the seat on F's immediate left lies between F and C; A, who sits between E and F, must be on F's right, with E next to A. B cannot sit next to E, so B takes the seat between F and C and D the one between C and E: D is immediately to the left of C.

Q.4 · Answer (D) + and ×

Interchanging + and ×: 56 ÷ 8 + 45 × 4 − 23 = 7 + 180 − 23 = 164.

Q.6 · Answer (B) AAUR

Each letter moves 7 places forward: J → Q, D → K, A → H and E → L, N → U, H → O. So T → A (wrapping round after Z), N → U and K → R: AAUR.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 5
T is the only letter in both words and 5 the only digit in both codes, so T = 5.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 66
Each pair is two consecutive cubes plus 2: 127 = 5^3 + 2 and 218 = 6^3 + 2; 3 = 1^3 + 2 and 10 = 2^3 + 2. So 29 = 3^3 + 2 goes with 4^3 + 2 = 66.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 9
E is the only letter in both words and 9 the only digit in both codes, so E = 9.

Q.11 · Answer (C) BNJM
Each letter moves 6 places forward: F → L, R → X, N → T, Q → W and X → D (wrapping round after Z), J → P, F → L, I → O. So V → B, H → N, D → J and G → M: BNJM.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 101
After interchanging the signs: 13 × 3 + 4 × 9 + 10 × 3 – 20 ÷ 5 = 39 + 36 + 30 – 4 = 101.

Q.14 · Answer (D) ip
'fast' is the only word in both sentences and 'ip' the only code in both, so fast = ip.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 4
Placing G third to A's right, D third to G's right, E between A and F, and C third to F's right gives, going round to each person's left: A, D, C, B, G, F, E. Counting rightwards from E, F, G, B and C come before D: 4 people.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 123
The differences are 4, 9, 16 and 25, the squares of 2 to 5, so the next is 6^2 = 36: 87 + 36 = 123.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Only conclusion (I) is follow .
All papers are files and all files are secret, so all papers are secret (I). Nothing says every secret thing is a file, so II does not follow.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
Nothing links the oranges to the kiwis: every orange may or may not be a kiwi, so I does not follow. All oranges being apples does not make all apples oranges, so II does not follow either.

Q.20 · Answer (B) YZX
Each letter moves 5 places forward from one cluster to the next: E, J, O, T, Y; F, K, P, U, Z; D, I, N, S, X. The next cluster is YZX.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Khasi uprising
Tirot Sing, a Khasi chief, led the Khasi uprising against the British in the Khasi Hills (1829-33).

Q.2 · Answer (B) Dadabhai Naoroji
Dadabhai Naoroji was the first to discuss a poverty line: he priced a prisoner's diet to arrive at a 'jail cost of living'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 1905
Lord Curzon announced the partition of Bengal in 1905; it took effect on 16 October 1905 and was annulled in 1911.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Kathakali
Kathakali, the dance-drama of Kerala, draws its stories from the Ramayana, the Mahabharata and the Puranas.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Sanskrit
Vishakhadatta's 'Mudrarakshasa', a political drama about Chanakya and Chandragupta Maurya, is written in Sanskrit.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Southern India
The Dravidian style of temple architecture belongs to southern India; the Nagara style is the northern one.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Must hold any office of profit
Under Article 58 a President must be a citizen of India, at least 35 years old and qualified for election to the Lok Sabha, and is not eligible while holding an office of profit under the government.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Lodi dynasty
Bahlul Lodi defeated Husain Shah Sharqi and annexed the Sharqi kingdom of Jaunpur to the Delhi Sultanate.

Q.9 · Answer (D) catenation
Catenation is carbon's ability to bond with other carbon atoms into long chains and rings. Tetravalency is its valency of four.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Bhutia
Losoong, the Sikkimese new year marking the end of the harvest, is chiefly a festival of the Bhutias.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Mukund Nayak
Mukund Nayak, a Nagpuri folk singer and dancer from Jharkhand, received the Padma Shri in 2017.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Violin
Ganesh and Kumaresh Rajagopalan are a Carnatic violin duo; their Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for 2018 was for the violin.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Typhoid
The Widal test detects antibodies against Salmonella Typhi, the bacterium that causes typhoid.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Haryana
Sumit Nagal, the tennis player, comes from Jhajjar in Haryana.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Raghav Chadha
Raghav Chadha, then the Aam Aadmi Party's Rajya Sabha MP, received the honour in London in January 2023, in the government and politics category.

Q.16 · Answer (B) ICC World Cup Men Cricket 2019 – England and Wales
England and Wales hosted the 2019 ICC Men's Cricket World Cup. The 2015 edition was held in Australia and New Zealand, 2011 in India, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, and 2007 in the West Indies.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Sedimentary rock
Sedimentary rocks form as layers of sediment are laid down and compacted, so they show layers (strata) of varying thickness.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Odisha
Panchpatmali, in Koraput district of Odisha, is one of India's largest bauxite deposits, mined by NALCO.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Dietary Fibre
Dietary fibre (roughage) adds bulk and helps food move through the gut; too little of it leads to constipation.

Q.20 · Answer (C) The Constitution of Ireland
The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV) were borrowed from the Irish Constitution.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 500
The Union Budget 2023-24 proposed 500 new 'waste to wealth' plants under GOBARdhan: 200 compressed biogas plants and 300 community or cluster-based plants.

Q.22 · Answer (A) JD Salinger
'The Catcher in the Rye' (1951) is J. D. Salinger's novel, narrated by Holden Caulfield.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Money
BHIM stands for Bharat Interface for Money, the UPI app of the National Payments Corporation of India.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 74.04%
Census 2011 put India's literacy rate at 74.04%: 82.14% for men and 65.46% for women.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Cotton textile industry
The cotton textile industry, which draws its raw cotton from the farm, is India's largest agro-based industry.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) calender
The correct spelling is 'calendar'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Spanish person are well known worldwide
The singular 'person' cannot take 'are' or stand for a whole nation: 'Spanish people are well known worldwide'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Conspicuous
'Unobtrusive' means not attracting attention; its opposite is 'conspicuous'. 'Obscure' and 'faint' are close to synonyms.

Q.4 · Answer (B) good of the individual
The phrase is 'for the good of': 'for the good of the individual, the society, the country and the world'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) goes the extra mile
To 'go the extra mile' is to make more effort than is expected; 'turns a deaf ear' (refuses to listen) contradicts 'to help people'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Solitary
A 'recluse' lives apart from others and avoids company; as an adjective the word means 'solitary'. 'Sociable' is its opposite.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Defiant
'Intractable' means hard to control or deal with: 'defiant'. 'Compliant' is its opposite.

Q.8 · Answer (B) The athlete ran quickly across the finish line.
Only this sentence spells 'athlete', 'quickly' and 'finish' correctly.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Having belief in yourself is the biggest key to success.
SSC's key gives 'the biggest key to success': the superlative, which ranks belief in yourself above every other key. 'The big key' is not ungrammatical in itself, though it reads oddly; 'the bigger key' needs a 'than', and 'the most bigger' doubles the comparison.

Q.12 · Answer (D) action
An 'action' is what is taken: 'no action taken yet'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) the cleverest
'One of the' takes a superlative and a plural noun: 'one of the cleverest men I have ever met'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) She singing romantic songs.
The present continuous needs its auxiliary: 'She is singing romantic songs'. The other three sentences are correct.

Q.15 · Answer (A) It is strange to see a guy shouting in the mall without any reason.
'Too' goes with the positive degree, not 'stranger', and 'beside any reason' should be 'without any reason'. Only 'It is strange to see ...' is correct.

Q.16 · Answer (A) sustainability
The correct spelling is 'sustainability'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) just the same
'It is all one' means it makes no difference: 'just the same'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Perseverance
'Perseverance' is continued effort to achieve something despite difficulty. 'Perspicacious' means shrewd, a 'euphemism' is a mild word for a harsh one, and to 'recant' is to take back a statement.

Q.19 · Answer (C) maze
A 'maze' is a confusing network of paths in which one gets lost; 'maize' (corn) only sounds the same.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Fleeting
'Evanescent' means quickly fading or passing: 'fleeting'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) makes
The subject 'It' is singular and the passage is in the simple present ('endeavours', 'promotes'): 'It makes no discriminations'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) relieve
To 'relieve' suffering is to ease it.

Q.23 · Answer (D) their
The needs are the individuals' own: 'their needs'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) most
Priority goes to 'the most urgent cases', the superlative after 'the'.

Q.25 · Answer (C) amongst
Peace 'amongst all people': 'amongst' is used for relations within a group of more than two.

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